[LIT-STRY-006] Shimwui Chumpha

Translation: The Granary Opening: A Festival Story

Work Type: SHORT_STORY | Creator: V. Ruivah | Year: 2002
Village: Somdal | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: Anthropological Literary Series, Imphal
Clearance: Scholarly Publication | Permission: permitted | Status: verified

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Themes: The harvest thanksgiving festival and granary opening (*Chumpha Phanit*), Customary wealth redistribution and social welfare for vulnerable

Structure & Meter: Observational social realism short story alternating descriptive ritua

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Critical Overview: Written by anthropologist and literary writer V. Ruivah,
this story documents the institutional generosity embedded in the

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Kashung winter chiko kashungli Somdal ramli Chumpha phanit kaphong kasha
Mayarnao Luingamna shim-wui mum eina atonao eili ngateitekha chum-kashak
Chum-wui khamahon kachashung eina awungana ancestral invocation chants h
'Kazing-Awunga, luikashak wui chara hi kazeiram eina ngaleili kapam kash
Chumpha wui thotharan kashunao kala kacham-kacham miyaongao kachiva-li c
Luingamna theilaga, 'Tangkhul ngashan mirin hi chara theikhavai maningma

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

In the cold crisp days of early winter, Somdal village prepared for the
Young Luingam accompanied his grandfather and family elders to the ances
With measured solemnity, the village headman recited the ancient granary
'O Sovereign Creator, bless this golden harvest of terrace rice so that
During Chumpha, harvested grain is systematically apportioned to widows,
Watching this generous distribution, young Luingam realized that Tangkhu

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Chumpha : Sacred winter harvest festival marking the formal
* Chum : Customary raised timber granary built separate fro
* Chara : Harvested unhusked rice / paddy grain, sacred gift